

The following text is for questions No. 11 and 12.

CORIANDER



Coriander is a member of the parsley (*Apiaceae*) family and can refer to both an herb and a spice. It is an annual plant that grows on slender green stems. The plant can grow up to three feet tall and the leaves resemble parsley leaves. When coriander flowers, it produces white flowers, with a hint of purple, and round, light brown seeds.

These seeds can be harvested and used as spices. Coriander grows as a native plant around the world, including Europe, Asia, Africa and in the Americas.

The dried seeds are what we know as coriander, and they have been used as a culinary spice and food-poisoning preventative agent for ages. Coriander seeds are round and tannish brown. As a spice, it is either sold whole or ground with a flavor similar to a blend of lemon, sage and caraway. They have a bit of a spicy, citrus flavor and are available in the spice aisle of most markets.

Coriander seeds not only offer a unique and intriguing flavor profile, but their consumption has also been shown to blood flow and heart health as well as to calm serious digestive problems. That is because coriander contains a multitude of bioactive that lead to a wide array of pharmacological activities, including its ability to act as an antimicrobial, anti-epileptic, antidepressant, anti-mutagenic, anti-inflammatory and anxiety inhibitor. It has also been shown to help lower cholesterol, blood pressure and blood sugar naturally.

Adapted from: <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/life-style>

11. After reading the text, the readers will
- A. be able to explain the history of coriander
 - B. know how to consume coriander properly
 - C. know the benefits of coriander for health
 - D. find out how to grow coriander well

12. "people ... the coriander seeds as culinary spice and food-poisoning preventative agent for long." The appropriate word to complete the sentence above is
- A. have used
 - B. are using
 - C. used
 - D. use

The following text is for questions No. 13 and 14.

The Oak and the Reeds



A Giant Oak stood near a brook in which grew some slender Reeds. When the wind blew, the great Oak stood proudly upright with its hundred arms uplifted to the sky. But the Reeds bowed low in the wind and sang a sad and mournful song.

"You have reason to complain," said the Oak.

"The slightest breeze that ruffles the surface of the water makes you bow your heads, while I, the mighty Oak, stand upright and firm before the howling tempest."

"Do not worry about us," replied the Reeds. "The winds do not harm us. We bow before them and so we do not break. You, in all your pride and strength, have so far resisted their blows. But the end is coming."

As the Reeds spoke a great hurricane rushed out of the north. The Oak stood proudly and fought against the storm, while the yielding Reeds bowed low. The wind redoubled in fury, and all at once the great tree fell, torn up by the roots, and lay among the pitying Reeds.

Taken from <http://read.gov/aesop/005.html>

13. Why didn't the Reeds fight against the storm like the Oak?
- A. They knew they're weak and would be a fool to do so.
 - B. They were just not as strong as the Oak to fight.
 - C. They were terrified with the storm.
 - D. The storm wasn't harmful to them.

14. What lesson do we learn from the text above?

- A. There are many who pretend to despise and belittle that which is beyond their reach.
- B. Better to yield when it is foolish to resist, than to resist stubbornly and be destroyed.
- C. Never insult others to do bad things, for the bad lucks may be upon you.
- D. When we are weak, then it is useless to show our potentials to others.

The following text is for questions No. 15 to 17.



J.K. Rowling

Joanne K. Rowling was born on 31st July 1965 at Yate General Hospital just outside Bristol, and grew up in Gloucestershire in England and in Chepstow, Gwent, in south-east Wales.

Her father, Peter, was an aircraft engineer at the Rolls Royce factory in Bristol and her mother, Anne, was a science technician in the Chemistry department at Wydean Comprehensive, where Jo herself went to school.

The young Jo grew up surrounded by books. "I lived for books," She has said. "I was your basic common-or-garden bookworm, complete with freckles and National Health spectacles."

Jo wanted to be a writer from an early age. She wrote her first book at the age of six – a story about a rabbit, called 'Rabbit'. At just eleven, she wrote her first novel – about seven cursed diamonds and the people who owned them.

Jo left home at eighteen for Exeter University, where she read so widely outside her French and Classics syllabus that she clocked up a fine of £50 for overdue books at the University library. Her knowledge of Classics would one day **come in handy** for creating the spells in the Harry Potter series, some of which are based on Latin.

Source: <https://articlebio.com/j-k-rowling>

15. What is the topic of the text above?
- The educational background of J.K. Rowling
 - The early publication of J.K. Rowling
 - The start of J.K. Rowling's writing
 - The parents of J.K. Rowling
16. Why did Rowling get a fine of £50? It was because she
- needed them to cast a spell on her friends
 - missed the due of the books she borrowed
 - read them for her French and Classics classes
 - tried to make some spells for the Harry Potter series
17. The italic phrases *come in handy* in the last paragraph can be best replaced with ...
- handful
 - helpful
 - hopeful
 - hateful

The following text is for questions No. 18 and 19.

Dear Mr. Wallin,

I would like to thank you again for your help with my case. The results were great and I appreciate your candor and honesty with my situation. I am pleased with the outcome and your handling of the case. I will gladly recommend your services to any of my friends or family that may ever need it. Thank you again for your help.

Sincerely,



Marc B

18. What was the aim of the writer sending this short message? It was to

- A. congratulate his friend
- B. say his sympathy
- C. send best wishes
- D. say thank you

19. What would the reader do after he receives this short message? He probably would

- A. get angry
- B. call the writer
- C. talk to his friend
- D. throw away the letter

20. One evening in the Incredibles' house.

Mom : "Violet, do you see Jack?"

Violet : "He was cleaning the swimming pool when I arrived from school this afternoon."

Dad : "I thought he was watering the plants in the yard."

Dash : "No, he's finished that, Dad. Now he's watching TV."

From the dialog above, we may assume that

- A. the swimming pool was clean when Violet arrived home
- B. the plants have been watered that evening
- C. the TV was watching Jack sleeping
- D. no one knows where Jack is